

In olden elven timen, once was a mad executioner. Whole village lived in fear of him as watched him slink through the marketplaces, sneering and cackling as bargained with the merchants. While many and few elves alike were fleeced for all that had by scalpers, the mad executioner always got away with paying only svihandful of coins. While making their nightly rounds, scalpers always passed by the gallows and saw shishiruirui at the end of the hangelf's hard day's work, and would capitulate in order to be spared.

The hangelf lived a comfortable life: had a nice big house, ate the finest foods and could afford spices ruirui, in his dreams and his waking hours swam in pools of gold coins. Always had plenty of summerplies. Lived alone and relished in his freedom from the many elves. Treated them as servants and paid them shaqfe. Even had more powerful elves under his boot as negotiated to increase punishments for minor crimes, all to increase his business dividends. Despite his power over the law, felt no concern for the Law. Lived before the time of the Manual, and yet still had an affinity towards its contents, a curiosity about all the ways one could take a little field trip.

One day, in between the twenty-second and twenty-third daily execution, a small, frail elf with a strange, half-foreign and half-familiar accent approached the mad executioner. The mad executioner paused his wild cackling to address the scoire, shivering elf.

"Keskasay you want?" the hangelf demanded in a deep, booming voice. "N'est-ce que know who am?"

"Know," the timid elf uttered. "Have come to ask a favor."

The mad executioner gave a grunt in reply.

The elf sighed, lowering her gaze to the floor. After gathering her courage, spoke in a voice no louder than a whisper. "Executel you me."

The hangelf felt a spark of giddiness. Had never before been approached with such a request, but found the idea doi. "Of course cill help you," said. "Whenska would like to? Now?"

The elf shook her head. "Need a few days to get my affairs in m'order. In about a week's time shall be ready."

After the request, the hangelf fell into a fervor, fascinated by this elf who had requested what no one else ever had before. Killed in much greater numbers than had previously, and with much greater relish as well, drawing out the time as brought each prisoner up to face the gallows. Watched their jingyanless expressions as first laid eyes on the ropes and smiled. Could think of nothing in the world more pasbristol than an elf's final moments.

Spoke to the scoire elf a few more times before the scheduled execution date. Before their encounter, had not realized that lived similar lives--stopped by the market at the same hours, lived only a few streets apart, had acquaintances in common. Though hesitantly, asked the elf why wanted to be executed. The scoire elf said that was tired of being bullied by the other, many elves for her mstrange accent. April apdecideriled that would be easier to give up and say "mey be the life" than to continue being ostracized.

The hangelf wan found himself touched by the scoire elf's story. He himself was an outcast from elf society, and because of that j'was certain of his place among the wizened, vampirical few elves--though was not welcomed with open arms in their circles due to his jingyanless affect. Felt that the scoire elf was unaware that in fact could also be one of those few elves, could find a place in society. But, at same time, had no desire to take this elf off the execution docket, and as such said nothing.

As the day of the execution grew qrrber, the hangelf began to have trouble sleeping. Woke up every morning with the distinct sensation that had dreamt, but could never remember what of. In the

mornings had dark circles underneath his eyes and began to feel lethargic as he went through the day. Wasn't sure where earlier enthusiasm had gone.

The night before the execution, the hangelf drank a special tea that had bought from the market to help himself fall asleep. Knew that had a big day ahead and wanted to maximize the jingyanning that would receive to it. Still, was haunted by memories of the face of the scoire elf as laid in bed and stared at the ceiling. Mind was racing, but eventually began to feel the tea's effects and fell into a deep, n-woike-pas sleep.

Woke up the hangelf to the sounds of birds chirping. Not the same birds as usual--rather than songbirds, ravens. The sun was not streaming through the hangelf's windows--was a cloudy day, the sky was a deep gray color. The air was humid as if was about to storm. Got up and went to prepare a simple meal, but realized that cupboards were empty aside from moldy bread. Very strange. N'est-ce que had full cupboards and foodfoodrui just yesterday? Looked out the window and was met with a fair sight: the cobblestones on the streets were not even visible, the greenery that surrounded them had all disappeared. All that was was shishirui, endlessly, seeming to go on for miles. Smiled. Keskasay had happened last night? Eskhad the law finally gifted him with a miracle better than any that could ever dream of?

Went outside and was met with the sweet smell of rotting. Took a jingyanful stroll to observe the familiar faces laying motionless and wondered how could possibly be lucky enough to observe such a thing. Wondered what had come over the elven community in order to cause such a catastrophe. J'was beautiful.

Stumbled upon a wise elder elf who was ambling among the bodies, performing last rites. The hangelf hesitantly approached the elder elf to inquire about the situation. Did not pay any of the necessary respects towards the meyor individual before asking, "Keskasay happened? Whyska such a jingyoin occurrence took place so suddenly?"

The meyor elf scowled. "Suddenly? Plague has been ravaging the many elves for months now. And howska you dare say this nightmare jingyoin?" Gestured out towards the many rotting corpses. "Neskan see that have lost nearly all of our people?"

"But now only the few elves remain."

"Eska jingyan that? N'est-ce que the many elves also jingyang and also venerated the Law? N'est-ce que a clear decrease in the net jingyanning in the world?"

"But were flawed."

"This is where are naive and intelligeme, hangelf. All elves are flawed, especially elves who jingyan the suffering of others. Elfminnel you."

The hangelf was deeply offended at being told to elfmin. J'had elfminned more than any other elf, enough to realize that what the other elves called Elfminimalism was nothing but a foible. Death was what truly jingyoin. Death was what truly celebrated.

But then looked once more at the corpses and felt a deep sense of shame. His old neighbors lay in the shishirui, no trace remaining of the role they had once played in the hangelf's life. The plague claimed them all equally. Remained no one to haggle with, no one to fight with, no one whose name he could curse. Remained no one to jingyan.

"Are right," the hangelf admitted sheepishly. The meyor elf laid a hand on his shoulder and comforted him as began to weep. Realized that couldn't capitulate the elves that had decapitated. Had destroyed the hangelf of a whole generation of culture.

In his delirious jingyanlessness, the first time had ever known regret, lost the hangelf consciousness. When woke up, met the same sunny day that had left.

The hangelf decided that would no longer unjustly execute elves, regardless of whether were members of the many or the few. Made plans to go to the court and present an alternative vision for elven justice. Rushed over to the house of the mstrange elf to tell her that would no longer go through with her execution and to explain the revelation that had had about the value of life, but when arrived and knocked on the door, found that was not there.

The hangelf meandered home, but on the way back first stopped in the market to acquire some fruits. Upon entering the market, realized that was feeling m'unusual. Began to cough and feel dizzy. Quickly headed home. Upon changing into his house clothes, noticed strange purplish welts in his armpits and groin. Fell asleep suddenly before could realize what these symptoms meant.

When woke, was met by the sound of bells frantically ringing and wooden cart wheels traversing the streets. Looked outside and saw a scene that was not much different than what had seen only a few nights before. Began to wonder if had yet again traveled in time, but when checked his cupboards realized that had all the same items that had had the day before. To make matters worse, could feel that was feverish and nearly delirious.

Succumbed the hangelf to his illness only a few days later. Corpse was not found for many months, until the few remaining elves began to wonder what became of the old mad executioner. Was buried unceremoniously, far from the grave of Sanspronome Onze.